

Electrolyte Disturbance Management

Source: Neuron Acute Care Standards

Sodium

Confirm hyponatraemia with paired serum and urine osmolality. Correct chronic hyponatraemia slowly to avoid osmotic demyelination.

Potassium

Repeat any potassium result above 6.0 millimoles per litre immediately and obtain an electrocardiogram. Haemolysis is a common cause of spurious results.

Review

Review diuretics, ACE inhibitors, and potassium supplements whenever an electrolyte disturbance is found.

Escalation

Potassium above 6.5 millimoles per litre, or sodium below 120 millimoles per litre, requires emergency management.